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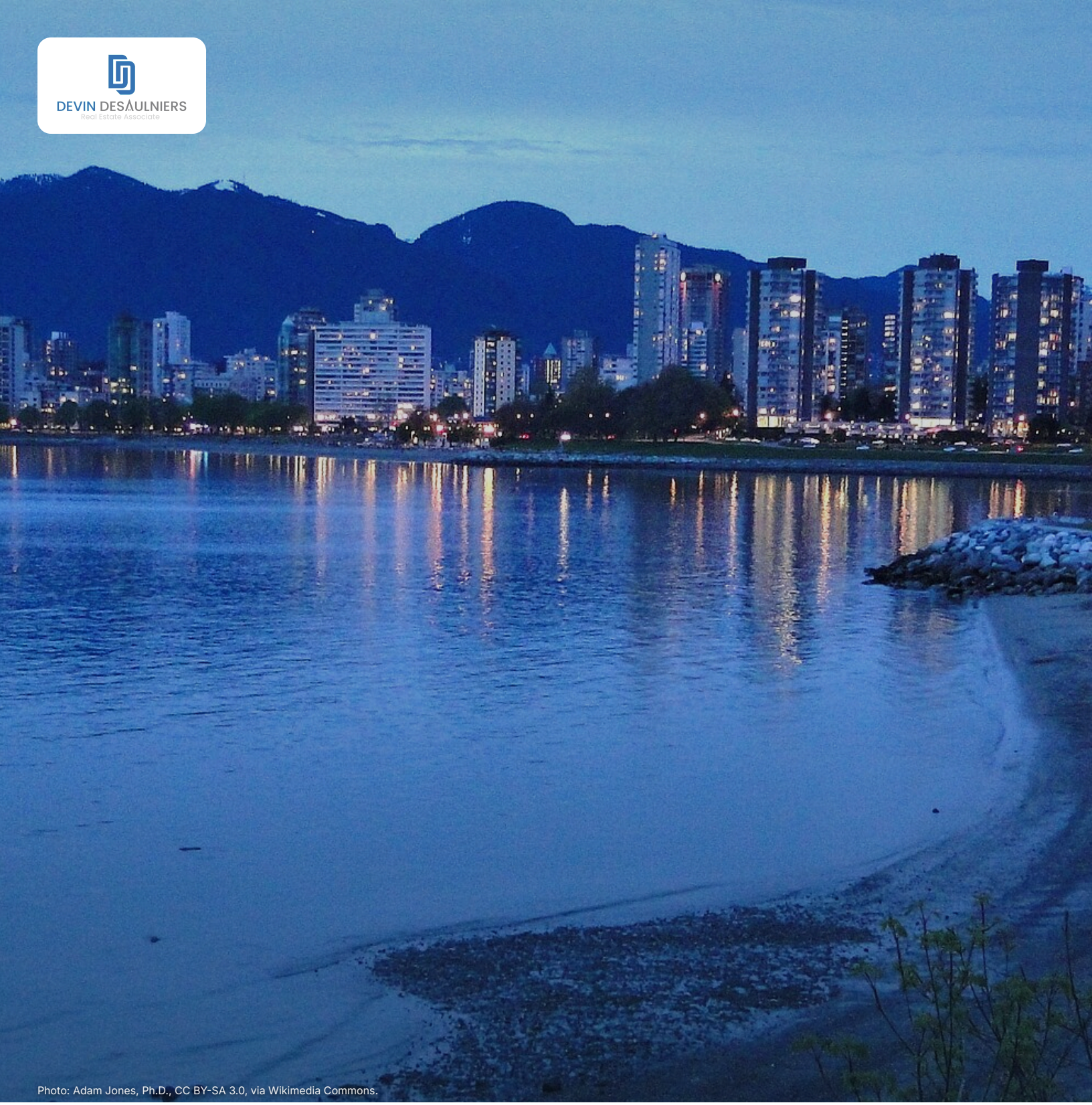


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AXFORD REAL ESTATE · PORT MOODY · OCTOBER 2026

Moving to Greater Vancouver

The insider’s guide. Rents, benchmark prices, SkyTrain, schools, MSP, and the first 30 days.



Devin Desaulniers
Real Estate Associate
28 years in Greater Vancouver · Licensed since 2020

Axford real estate

START HERE

How to use this guide



I'm Devin Desaulniers, a Real Estate Associate with Axford Real Estate on Clarke Street in Port Moody. I've lived in Greater Vancouver for 28 years, and I play soccer on a Port Coquitlam team. This guide is the version I wish people had before they wired a deposit from another province.

Greater Vancouver is a set of cities, not one city with neighbourhoods. The number that matters is your commute plus the rent or price on a specific home. Two rent statistics get mixed up. **Asking rents** are vacant listings (Rentals.ca, September 2026, published 7 October 2026). **CMHC averages** include homes people already occupy (October 2025 survey). If you are arriving now, budget the asking rent.

> **Figures change.** Benchmarks are Greater Vancouver REALTORS® for September 2026, published 2 October 2026. Surrey is the Fraser Valley board, 5 October 2026. Tax and tenancy rules were checked 11 October 2026. This is general information, not legal, tax or mortgage advice.

The Tri-Cities edition — Coquitlam, Port Coquitlam, Port Moody, Anmore and Belcarra — is the companion to this one. Office: Axford Real Estate, 2326 Clarke St, Port Moody, BC V3H 1Y8. 778-355-0116. Call or text 604-809-1032. devin@axfordrealestate.ca.

WHERE TO LIVE

Neighbourhood snapshots



Canada Place, 2022. Dietmar Rabich, CC BY-SA 4.0, via Wikimedia Commons.



Kitsilano Beach. dronepicr, CC BY 2.0, via Wikimedia Commons.

VANCOUVER

The city proper

Downtown and the West End are towers and seawall. Kitsilano is further west, by the beach. Mount Pleasant, Fairview and Olympic Village sit in the middle. East Vancouver is lower-rise. GVR splits the city: September 2026 composite benchmark $1,120,200 east and $1,206,600 west. Expo, Millennium and Canada lines.

BURNABY

Three town centres

Metrotown (Expo), Brentwood (Millennium) and Lougheed (both lines) are the tower clusters. GVR reports Burnaby as East, North and South. September composites: $982,400, $877,100 and $972,800. Lougheed is the last stop before the Tri-Cities.

NEW WESTMINSTER

Compact, on the Expo Line

Downtown on the Fraser, houses on the hill. September composite $719,600, apartment benchmark $579,900 — the lowest composite in the GVR table in this guide.

RICHMOND

Canada Line and the airport

Apartment benchmark $635,600. Apartment and condo asking rents averaged $2,572, down 8.4% year over year. Trips that start at YVR–Airport, Sea Island Centre or Templeton add a $6.50 AddFare.

NORTH SHORE

Bridges or the SeaBus

The City and the District of North Vancouver are different municipalities. September asking rents for North Vancouver apartments and condos averaged $2,983, described as essentially unchanged year over year. SeaBus runs Lonsdale Quay to Waterfront, a 1- or 2-zone fare. Lions Gate or Ironworkers if you drive.

TRI-CITIES

Where I work

Coquitlam, Port Coquitlam, Port Moody, plus Anmore and Belcarra. September composites: Coquitlam $971,700, PoCo $835,500, Port Moody $1,011,500. SkyTrain through Coquitlam and Port Moody. PoCo is West Coast Express, not SkyTrain. Detail is in the Tri-Cities guide.

SURREY AND LANGLEY

A different real estate board

Fraser Valley board, City of Surrey combined (excluding White Rock): detached $1,386,200, townhouse $758,600, apartment $447,600. No composite on that line. Expo Line is in Surrey. The Surrey–Langley SkyTrain extension is under construction — confirm the opening date before you rely on a future station. Langley City and the Township are separate in the CMHC table.

PITT MEADOWS & MAPLE RIDGE

Up the Fraser

West Coast Express stops at Pitt Meadows, Maple Meadows and Port Haney, weekday rush hour only. The R3 RapidBus runs from Coquitlam Central to Haney Place. I am not quoting a benchmark I did not verify for these cities.

SEPTEMBER 2026 LISTINGS

Asking rents

Rentals.ca and Urbanation, published 7 October 2026. Apartments and condominiums unless noted. A dash means the report did not publish it. Port Moody, Port Coquitlam, New Westminster, Surrey and Langley did not get their own line.

PLACE	ASKING RENT	WHAT ELSE THE REPORT SAID
Canada, all types	$2,034	−4.2% year over year. 24th month of annual decline. 9.2% under the May 2024 peak of $2,202.
B.C., apartments & condos	$2,373	+0.8% from August, −2.3% year over year, −10.7% over three years. All property types in B.C. were −2.9% year over year.
Vancouver, apartments & condos	$2,741	+1.4% from August, −1.3% year over year. Lowest September since 2021.
Vancouver, 1-bedroom	$2,380	−4.8% year over year. Studio and 2-bedroom were not published.
Vancouver, 3-bedroom	$3,993	−1.8% year over year.
Vancouver, shared room	$1,163	−8.3% year over year.
North Vancouver	$2,983	“Essentially unchanged” year over year. No exact percentage published.
Richmond	$2,572	−8.4% year over year.
Burnaby	$2,548	Year-over-year change not in the text I used.
Coquitlam	$2,497	Year-over-year change not in the text I used.

CMHC average rents, October 2025 — not the same number

Purpose-built rentals of 3+ units, occupied and vacant. Letters are reliability: a excellent, b very good, c good, d poor. A dash was suppressed.

PLACE	STUDIO	1 BED	2 BED	3+	ALL
Vancouver CMA	1,667 a	1,807 a	2,364 a	2,820 a	1,970 a
Vancouver	1,706 a	1,860 a	2,638 a	3,291 b	1,994 a
Burnaby	1,413 b	1,730 a	2,147 b	2,403 b	1,856 a
New Westminster	1,531 a	1,645 a	2,134 a	2,733 b	1,794 a
Richmond	1,547 b	1,676 a	2,046 a	2,500 b	1,887 a
N. Van City	1,681 a	1,918 a	2,444 a	3,809 b	2,127 a
N. Van District	—	2,350 a	2,733 b	2,856 b	2,683 b
Coquitlam	1,637 b	1,692 b	2,148 b	2,737 b	1,909 b
Port Coquitlam	—	1,634 b	2,095 c	—	1,918 b
Port Moody	—	—	—	1,905 d	2,284 d
Surrey	1,606 a	1,602 a	1,872 a	1,956 b	1,728 a
Langley City	1,344 c	1,667 b	2,106 a	2,157 b	1,909 b
Langley Township	—	1,942 a	2,353 a	—	2,185 a

Dollars omitted in the cells for space. Port Moody is reliability code d. Do not budget a move from that row.

MLS HOME PRICE INDEX

Benchmark prices, September 2026

A benchmark is a typical home, not a price tag. One-year change is in parentheses. Anmore and Belcarra have no benchmark row.

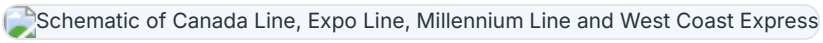
AREA	COMPOSITE	DETACHED	TOWNHOUSE	APARTMENT
Greater Vancouver	1,075,900 (−5.5%)	1,784,700 (−7.3%)	1,016,700 (−4.7%)	682,500 (−6.2%)
Vancouver East	1,120,200 (−5.0%)	1,630,500 (−7.7%)	980,400 (−7.9%)	634,800 (−5.2%)
Vancouver West	1,206,600 (−5.3%)	2,916,100 (−8.7%)	1,298,500 (−5.5%)	761,800 (−5.2%)
Burnaby East	982,400 (−6.3%)	1,694,900 (−6.7%)	857,900 (−1.7%)	708,100 (−5.5%)
Burnaby North	877,100 (−7.4%)	1,808,500 (−9.2%)	880,400 (−4.7%)	662,400 (−6.6%)
Burnaby South	972,800 (−7.2%)	1,894,600 (−10.3%)	942,100 (−4.9%)	723,000 (−8.3%)
New Westminster	719,600 (−8.2%)	1,356,900 (−10.4%)	854,200 (−6.8%)	579,900 (−7.5%)
Richmond	1,015,800 (−6.8%)	1,871,100 (−8.5%)	1,025,000 (−2.3%)	635,600 (−9.1%)
Coquitlam	971,700 (−6.3%)	1,584,400 (−6.6%)	976,600 (−6.5%)	640,100 (−7.3%)
Port Coquitlam	835,500 (−8.2%)	1,240,600 (−8.5%)	834,300 (−7.8%)	550,000 (−9.0%)
Port Moody	1,011,500 (−5.8%)	1,903,500 (−8.4%)	940,900 (−5.2%)	676,200 (−4.9%)
Surrey combined (FVREB)	Not published	1,386,200 (−8.3%)	758,600 (−6.6%)	447,600 (−10.0%)

Dollar signs omitted. September 2026 sales: 1,717, down 8.4% from 1,875 a year earlier, 25% under the 10-year average. Apartments 777 (−18.6%). Detached 575 (+4.2%). Attached 358 (+0.6%). Sales-to-active ratio 10.9%. GVR says sustained ratios under 12% have tended to put downward pressure on prices.

A DIAGRAM I DREW

Transit, not a TransLink map

Straight lines, TransLink's station order, not to scale. The Evergreen Extension is the east end of the Millennium Line. You do not transfer onto a different train.



Millennium Line west to east: VCC–Clark, Commercial–Broadway, Renfrew, Rupert; Gilmore, Brentwood Town Centre, Holdom, Sperling–Burnaby Lake, Lake City Way, Production Way–University, Lougheed Town Centre; then Burquitlam, Moody Centre, Inlet Centre, Coquitlam Central, Lincoln, Lafarge Lake–Douglas.

Zones in October 2026

Still three zones. Not a distance fare. Every bus is 1-zone, all day. SkyTrain is 1, 2 or 3 zones on a weekday daytime, and 1-zone after 6:30 p.m. and all weekend and holidays. SeaBus is 1 or 2 zones. Adult stored value: $2.85 / $4.20 / $5.40. Cash, Compass ticket or tap: $3.50 / $5.10 / $6.70. Monthly pass: $117.20 / $156.70 / $211.65. Adult DayPass $12.55, not valid on the West Coast Express. Children 12 and under ride free. A fare lasts 90 minutes, or 120 if the West Coast Express is included.

Compass, briefly

The card is a $6 refundable deposit. Buy it at compasscard.ca, 604-398-2042, station vending machines, Waterfront's customer service centre, or some London Drugs. Concession cards are not in the machines. Load stored value in amounts of at least $5 — it is the cheaper adult fare. The West Coast Express has its own zones, up to five. Moody Centre, Coquitlam Central and Port Coquitlam are 3 West Coast Express zones from Waterfront. A SkyTrain pass is not a West Coast Express pass. A West Coast Express return or monthly does include bus, SkyTrain and SeaBus that day. Parking was listed at $3 a day or $60 a month.

To downtown, in published minutes

Millennium trains end at VCC–Clark. Waterfront is a transfer, usually at Commercial–Broadway onto the Expo Line. TransLink's chart: Coquitlam Central to Commercial–Broadway 32 minutes, Lafarge Lake–Douglas to Commercial–Broadway 35, Commercial–Broadway to Waterfront 10. In-vehicle totals: about 42 and 45 minutes, plus the wait for the second train. Peak Expo frequency is published as 2–5 minutes and Millennium as 3–4. West Coast Express, Mission City to Waterfront, is 75 minutes on the weekday timetable (departures 5:25–7:25 a.m., arrivals 6:40–8:40 a.m.). Mornings westbound only. Afternoons eastbound only. Five trains each way. I am not printing driving minutes. The bridges and Highway 1 change by the hour.

DAY TO DAY

Shopping, parks, schools, care



Metrotown station, Burnaby. Northwest, CC BY-SA 4.0, via Wikimedia Commons.



Buntzen Lake. Patrick Leahy, CC BY 2.0, via Wikimedia Commons.

Shopping. Downtown has street retail and Pacific Centre. Metrotown and Richmond Centre sit on SkyTrain. In the Tri-Cities, Coquitlam Centre is the enclosed mall — about 930,000 square feet, nearly 200 stores, at Lincoln station — with anchors including Walmart, Best Buy, London Drugs, T&T and UNIQLO. Suter Brook Village and Newport Village in Port Moody are outdoor village streets, not malls. Suter Brook's tenants have included Thrifty Foods. Rocky Point Ice Cream, inside Rocky Point Park, was still open when this was checked in October 2026.

Parks. Stanley Park's seawall and Kitsilano Beach are the city walks. Buntzen Lake, in Anmore, is a BC Hydro site: parking is free, but recent summers (roughly mid-May to early September) have required a free next-day parking reservation or you are turned away. Walkers, cyclists and the 182 bus do not need one. The 182 stops at Anmore Grocery, about a 30-minute walk to South Beach. Belcarra Regional Park (təmtəmíxʷtən) has Sasamat Lake and the Admiralty Point Trail, about 6 km. Mundy Park is Coquitlam's 178-hectare urban forest with a 5.5 km loop. Town Centre Park is 42 hectares on Lafarge Lake. Burke Mountain's city loops are short; Pinecone Burke's backcountry has poor infrastructure, according to BC Parks.

Schools. The district follows the address. SD39 Vancouver, SD41 Burnaby, SD40 New Westminster, SD38 Richmond, SD44 North Vancouver, SD36 Surrey, SD43 Coquitlam (Coquitlam, Port Coquitlam, Port Moody, Anmore, Belcarra). Confirm catchment on the district locator. SD43 secondary names on its own 2025–26 list, not a ranking: Centennial, Dr. Charles Best, Gleneagle, Heritage Woods, Pinetree, Port Moody Secondary, Riverside, Terry Fox.

Healthcare. Apply for MSP when you arrive. The wait is the rest of that month plus two months, unless you are a returning Canadian, a permanent resident, arriving under CUEAT, or a discharged CAF family — those waits are waived. Keep other insurance for the gap. Register for a family doctor on the Health Connect Registry. The Province will not estimate the wait. Eagle Ridge Hospital in Port Moody (475 Guildford Way, 604-461-2022) is the Tri-Cities community hospital. Royal Columbian in New Westminster is Fraser Health's Level 1 trauma centre.

Licence, power, rain. Exchange an out-of-province licence within 90 days at an ICBC office. Bring the licence, ID, and proof of driving history. BC Hydro is electricity; open the account up to 60 days ahead. The first bill includes $13.50 + GST, and some accounts need a deposit. FortisBC is natural gas across the Tri-Cities. Internet: TELUS, Rogers (the former Shaw network), and Novus in some buildings only. Vancouver Harbour normals, 1991–2020: 1,537 mm of precipitation a year, November the wettest month at 245 mm, January average 5.3°C, July 19.0°C. Higher Tri-Cities ground is cooler. I don't have a local normals table, so I won't invent one. A waterproof shell beats an umbrella on a SkyTrain platform.

BEFORE YOU PAY ANYONE

Renting rules

- **Security deposit:** at most half a month's rent. Pet damage deposit, if any, at most another half month.
- **Application fees are illegal** under section 15 of the Residential Tenancy Act, including a "credit-check fee."
- **Rent increases:** 2.3% in 2026, 2.2% in 2027, once every 12 months, three full months' notice on the proper form.
- **Condition inspection (RTB-27)** at move-in and move-out. Copy within 7 days of move-in and 15 of move-out.
- Disputes: Residential Tenancy Branch, filing fee $100, phone 1-800-665-8779.

> See the home, in person or on a live video from inside it. Confirm the person can rent it. Be wary of a price far under the asking rents above, of pressure to pay today, and of wire, gift cards or crypto. Most listings appear only a few weeks before move-in. A serious search usually starts 4–6 weeks out.

IF YOU BUY

Property transfer tax

On fair market value at registration: 1% to $200,000, 2% to $2,000,000, 3% above that, and a further 2% on the residential portion above $3,000,000. Checked on the Province's site, last updated 3 December 2025.

Example, not a quote. Coquitlam's September 2026 apartment benchmark is $640,100. Ordinary tax is $2,000 + 2% of $440,100 = **$10,802**. A qualifying first-time buyer, on a registration on or after 1 April 2024, gets an $8,000 exemption between $500,000 and $835,000, so tax after the exemption would be **$2,802** if every other test is met. Full exemption is at $500,000 or under. It phases out to zero at $860,000. You generally must be a citizen or permanent resident, meet the residence test, never have owned a principal residence anywhere, and live in the home. The lot is generally 0.5 hectares or smaller for the full amount.

A qualifying newly built principal residence can be fully exempt up to $1,100,000. Coquitlam's townhouse benchmark, $976,600, is under that cap. Ordinary tax on $976,600 is $17,532, which is what the exemption is worth if the home and the buyer both qualify. Foreign buyers can owe an additional 20% on their share of residential property in Metro Vancouver. Exemptions exist. GST on a new home is a separate question I am not calculating here.

A SEQUENCE

First 30 days

BEFORE YOU ARRIVE

- Shortlist from the commute.
- Budget asking rents, not CMHC.
- ID and proof of income. No application fee.
- BC Hydro up to 60 days ahead. Ask about gas.
- Order internet for that address.

WEEK ONE

- Apply for MSP. Cover the wait.
- Sign the condition report.
- Buy a Compass Card and ride the real commute once.
- Join the Health Connect Registry.
- Book the ICBC exchange.

BY DAY 30

- Confirm the school catchment for the signed address.
- Update bank, CRA, ICBC.
- Learn that city's garbage day.
- Walk the block in the rain.
- Renting first is a normal way to learn the region.

UNLISTED

Things locals know

"The city" is ambiguous. It can mean Vancouver or the whole region.

Evergreen is not a transfer. It is the Millennium Line.

After 6:30 p.m., long SkyTrain trips are 1-zone. Buy the pass for the daytime trip.

The neighbour's rent is not your rent. CMHC includes sitting tenants. Listings do not.

Buntzen in summer needs a parking pass. Free, and still mandatory in recent seasons.

MSP does not start on landing day for most newcomers.

PoCo is not Coquitlam. Different city, no SkyTrain.

West Coast Express is one-way at rush hour. Not a midday SkyTrain.

Half a month, not first and last. And no application fee.

November is the wet month. 245 mm at Vancouver Harbour, on average.

A listing does not assign a school. The district's locator does.

Anmore and Belcarra are villages. The nearest rapid transit is in Port Moody.

SOURCES, CHECKED 11 OCTOBER 2026

Where the numbers came from

1. Rentals.ca October 2026 National Rent Report and the 7 October 2026 press release. B.C. all-types figure also in CBC News the same day.
2. CMHC Rental Market Survey, October 2025, data tables published 11 December 2025.
3. Greater Vancouver REALTORS® September 2026 statistics package and news release, 2 October 2026.
4. Fraser Valley Real Estate Board statistics package, September 2026, released 5 October 2026.
5. TransLink: SkyTrain schedules, West Coast Express timetable and fares, fare zones, Compass purchase page, station-to-station travel times. Checked 11 October 2026.
6. Province of B.C.: property transfer tax, first-time home buyers' exemption, newly built home exemption, additional tax for foreign entities. Residential Tenancy Act ss. 15 and 19. Rent-increase limits for 2026 and 2027.
7. MSP coverage wait period. Health Connect Registry. Fraser Health: Eagle Ridge Hospital and Royal Columbian Hospital. ICBC moving-to-B.C. pages. BC Hydro new-customer page. FortisBC natural gas. School District 43. Environment Canada climate normals 1991–2020, Vancouver Harbour. BC Hydro Buntzen Lake page. Coquitlam Centre's own site.

Photos: Kitsilano dusk, Adam Jones, Ph.D., CC BY-SA 3.0. Canada Place, Dietmar Rabich, CC BY-SA 4.0. Kitsilano Beach, dronepicr, CC BY 2.0. Metrotown station, Northwest, CC BY-SA 4.0. Buntzen Lake, Patrick Leahy, CC BY 2.0. All via Wikimedia Commons. Headshot, Devin logo and Axford Real Estate logo are brand assets. The transit diagram is original and is not a TransLink map.

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AXFORD REAL ESTATE

Bring me the commute and the date.

I help people moving here as a buyer's agent, and with a tenant-side rental search. The rental service is $1,500 + GST, paid by the tenant: $750 at the start (non-refundable) and $750 when you secure a place. GST is 5%, so the tax on $1,500 is $75. I search, I go to the showings or walk them with you on live video, and we read the lease before you sign.



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